

IDSN 599 CROWDFUNDING

QUALITATIVE VALIDATION

ASSIGNMENT 4

COOPER, FRANKLIN, ARYA, PARISSA, ABI

THE PRODUCT

Vexcite makes Tron-esque high-performance electric two-wheelers that bridge e-bikes and light e-motos, delivering motorcycle level performance and aesthetic without licensing friction.





PROBLEM SPACE

There is a big gap between more utilitarian e-bikes and high commitment motorcycles: people who want an exciting, fast, and good-looking way to get around feel underwhelmed by current e-bikes but don't want the risk, maintenance, or lifestyle commitment of a motorcycle.

PAIN POINTS

RANGE ANXIETY

“Range drops hard if you ride it the way you want to.”

— Lucas, 31, Weekly Rider (Onyx)

RELIABILITY & TRUST ISSUES

“On a camping trip, the bike shut off while I was riding — the screen turned off and the throttle stopped responding.”

— Oscar, 25, Thrill-Seeker Rider

MAINTENANCE & FRICTION IN DAILY LIFE

“The noise, the heat, and maintenance didn’t fit into my life as cleanly as I wanted it to.”

— Maya, 29, Former Gas Rider

FREQUENCY

CONSISTENT STRESS → REDUCED USAGE

“Honestly, I hardly ever ride anymore. Maybe once every couple months.”

— Armand, 27, Former Motorcycle Rider

ONGOING MAINTENANCE FRICTION

“I typically have to do bike or car maintenance about once a month.”

— Oscar, 25, Thrill-Seeker Rider

RANGE ISSUES AT HIGHER SPEEDS

“Once you start pushing it, you feel the limits pretty fast.”

— Lucas, 31, Weekly Rider (Onyx)

WORKAROUNDS

DEFAULTING BACK TO CARS

“I’m driving all day for work anyway, so I just default to it.”

— Armand, 27, Former Motorcycle Rider

RIDING DESPITE PROBLEMS

“I was upset for a bit and then just rode on the flat tire.”

— Grad Student, 22

CHOOSING LIGHTER VEHICLES

“I like how light the Onyx is... electric motorcycles feel like overkill.”

— Lucas, 31, Weekly Rider (Onyx)

CONSEQUENCES

LOST EXCITEMENT & EMOTIONAL PAYOFF

“Outside of moments like that, the excitement hasn’t been consistent.”

— Oscar, 25, Thrill-Seeker Rider

FAILURE TO CONVERT INTEREST INTO PURCHASE

“Everything was either too slow... or so fast and heavy that it felt like I was right back in motorcycle territory.”

— Maya, 29, Former Gas Rider

VEHICLES BECOME SITUATIONAL INSTEAD OF DAILY

“It’s great around the city... but at higher speeds you’re aware of its limits.”

— Lucas, 31, Weekly Rider (Onyx)

TOP 3 PERSONAS

Three distinct rider profiles emerged from our qualitative interviews.

**SPEED &
ADRENALINE
DRIVEN
RIDERS**

**DESIGN
ORIENTED
RIDERS**

**DAILY
URBAN
COMMUTERS**



TIP OF SPEAR

ANTONIO



THE SPEED & ADRENALINE
DRIVEN RIDER

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ABOUT

Antonio is a 25-year-old executive protection agent based in Downtown Los Angeles. He thrives on speed, adrenaline, and high-performance experiences, but approaches purchasing decisions with logic and caution. While excitement draws him in, trust, value, and long-term reliability ultimately determine whether a product is worth the investment.

KEY MOTIVATORS

- Excitement & adrenaline
- Financial stability & independence
- Discipline, family, and personal growth

PAIN POINT

- Rising costs and licensing barriers as e-bike speed increases

PURCHASE CAUTION

RISK TOLERANCE

PERFORMANCE SENSITIVITY



SIENNA



THE DESIGN ORIENTED RIDER

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ABOUT

Sienna is a design-forward urban professional who treats transportation as an extension of personal taste. Living in a major city, they seek products that balance performance with elevated aesthetics—prioritizing materials, finish, and presence as much as speed or range. Emotion drives initial attraction, but purchase decisions are validated through research, and confidence in quality.

KEY MOTIVATORS

- Identity Through Design
- Elevated Daily Experience
- Confidence Without Compromise

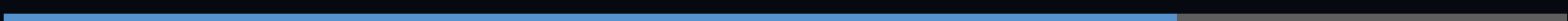
PAIN POINT

- She can't find a vehicle that looks genuinely premium and performs like one.

PERFORMANCE EXPECTATION



STATUS AWARENESS



DESIGN SENSITIVITY





STEVEN



THE DAILY COMMUTER

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ABOUT

Steven is a tech-driven urban professional who sees transportation as a productivity tool. Based in Downtown LA, he is frustrated by long, inefficient commutes that drain time and energy. Highly analytical and future-oriented, Steven values speed, reliability, and smart engineering—choosing solutions that help him reclaim time, project a forward-thinking image, and ambitious lifestyle.

KEY MOTIVATORS

- Time Efficiency
- Career & Future Focus
- Tech-Forward Identity

PAIN POINT

- His commute wastes hours every week and actively limits his career momentum.

EFFICIENCY ORIENTATION

FUTURE FOCUS

ANALYTICAL DECISION-MAKING

MARKET REALITY

The market exists – but every current solution forces painful tradeoffs. Riders are actively hacking around gaps between e-bikes and motorcycles.

SPEED & ADRENALINE RIDERS

What they use:

- Sur-Ron, Talaria, Onyx RCR, DIY mod builds, entry gas bikes

Where it works:

- Torque, excitement, fun-per-dollar

Where it fails:

- Speed ceilings (45–65 mph)
- Range collapse at high speeds
- Immediate mod tax + reliability risk

DESIGN-ORIENTED RIDERS

What they use:

- CAKE, Onyx, Super73, vintage/custom mopeds

Where it works:

- Visual identity
- Premium feel

Where it fails:

- Performance compromises
- Overpriced relative to capability
- Shallow tech + software

URBAN COMMUTERS

What they use:

- Cars, legal e-bikes, transit, light e-motos

Where it works:

- Familiarity, legality, reliability

Where it fails:

- Cars = overkill + traffic
- E-bikes = too slow
- Transit = time drain

THE VERDICT: PASS

WHY IT PASSES

All three personas independently describe the same unmet gap...

Riders are already:

- Spending thousands on mods
- Owning multiple vehicles
- Accepting unreliable DIY setups

Interview quotes show active frustration, not passive interest

- “Why can’t I just buy one machine that’s fast, long-range, and purpose-built?”

WHY ITS CONDITIONAL

Reliability anxiety is real (ex: Oscar’s shutdown incident)

Range expectations at speed must be honest
Trust must be earned early

The demand is validated. Execution – not desirability – is the risk.

A man with a beard and sunglasses is riding a black bicycle towards the camera. He is wearing a black t-shirt with a logo and light-colored shorts. The background shows an outdoor event with several black tents, palm trees, and other people. The text "THANK YOU" is overlaid in large white letters.

THANK YOU